

Indian Traditions, Culture and Society

India is a land of rich culture and tradition which teaches people kindness, generosity, and tolerance. Indian culture differs from place to place as it is a multilingual, multicultural, and multi-ethnic society. Indian culture is a unique blend of modern western culture and historical traditions.

- **Arts and Language:** The ancient Indian classical language, called Sanskrit, was one of the earliest Indo-European languages to be developed.
- **Philosophy and Religion:** Numerous significant religious traditions that developed within India have become globally important today.
- **Food and Drink:** The cuisine of India varies considerably across its various regions and ethnic communities.
- **Culture and Heritage:** Indian culture and traditions are bestowed with myriads of rituals, attitudes, beliefs, handicrafts, art forms and many others. The mystery of India is deep-rooted in the culture, tradition, rituals, and custom followed by the people. The culture and heritage of the nation can be viewed touring the several sites of the country.

India's culture is built upon centuries of history and heritage, making it one of the oldest in the world. Indian culture can trace its roots back centuries and enjoys some of the world's most vibrant and diverse traditions.

Module 1- Society State and Polity in India

1. **Society:** Society refers to a group of people who share a common culture, language, and territory. In India, society is diverse and complex, with a rich history and a wide range of cultural practices and traditions.
2. **State:** The state refers to the political organization of a country, including its government, laws, and institutions. In India, the state is a federal parliamentary democratic republic, with a President as the head of state and a Prime Minister as the head of government.
3. **Polity:** Polity refers to the system of government and the way in which political power is distributed and exercised. In India, the polity is based on the Constitution, which outlines the powers and responsibilities of the different branches of government and guarantees fundamental rights to all citizens.
4. **India's diversity:** India is a diverse country, with a population of over 1.3 billion people and a wide range of languages, religions, and cultures. This diversity is reflected in the country's political system, with different states having their own governments and political parties.
5. **Challenges:** India faces many challenges, including poverty, corruption, and inequality. The government is working to address these issues through various policies and programs, but progress has been slow in some areas.
6. **Opportunities:** Despite these challenges, India has many opportunities for growth and development. The country has a large and growing economy, a young and educated population, and a strategic location in the

world. With the right policies and investments, India has the potential to become a major global power.

State in Ancient India

- States in ancient India were loosely categorized into monarchy, republican, and oligarchy. Monarchy was the most prevalent type of state in ancient India.
- The state in ancient India was considered necessary, for it ensured peace, order, and happiness. It was a social organization with political power.
- Ancient scholars were not unanimous in their opinion with regard to the origin of the state. The three theories of the origin of the state in ancient India are as follows: 1. Social Contract Theory 2. Divine Origin Theory 3. Organic Theory.
- The core issues in the study of political science are the state and the government. The institution of the state is studied in relation to its origin, nature, aims, and functions of the state in ancient India.

Theories of origin of State in India

The origin of the state in ancient India has been a topic of interest for political scientists and historians. There are three main theories that have been proposed to explain the origin of the state in ancient India:

1. **Social Contract Theory:** This theory suggests that the state originated from an agreement between individuals to form a society and establish a government to protect their rights and maintain order.
2. **Divine Origin Theory:** This theory proposes that the state was created by a divine power and that the rulers were chosen by the gods to govern the people.
3. **Organic Theory:** This theory suggests that the state is a natural and organic growth from the family and the clan, and that it evolved over time to become a more complex and organized institution.

These theories provide different perspectives on the origin of the state in ancient India and the role of the government in society .

Evolutionary Theory of origin of State

The Evolutionary Theory of the origin of the state is one of the several theories that attempt to explain how states or governments came into existence. According to this theory, the state evolved from the family, which gradually grew in size and complexity as population increased and societies became more organized.

1. The theory suggests that the earliest form of human organization was the family, which was headed by the father or the eldest male member.

2. As families grew in size and number, they formed clans or tribes, which were larger kinship groups.
3. As population increased and societies became more complex, the need for a more formal system of governance arose.
4. The theory proposes that the state emerged as a natural progression from the family and clan/tribe system, as a means of providing for the common defense and welfare of the people.
5. The state, according to this theory, evolved gradually over time, as societies became more complex and the need for a more formal system of governance became apparent.

This theory is based on the idea that the state is a natural and necessary part of human society, and that it evolved gradually over time as societies became more complex. It is one of several theories that attempt to explain the origin of the state, and is often contrasted with other theories such as the Divine Right Theory, the Force Theory, and the Social Contract Theory.

Force Theory of origin of State

The Force Theory of the origin of the state is one of the several theories that attempt to explain how states came into existence. According to this theory, the state emerged as a result of the use of force by one group to subjugate another group. Here are some key points to consider:

1. The theory suggests that the state was created when one group or tribe conquered another group or tribe and established its rule over the conquered people.
2. The conquerors used force to maintain their control over the conquered people and to establish a system of government.
3. The use of force was necessary to maintain order and to protect the interests of the ruling group.
4. The ruling group established laws and institutions to govern the conquered people and to maintain their control over them.
5. Over time, the conquered people accepted the rule of the conquerors and the state became an established institution.

This theory has been criticized for its simplicity and for its failure to account for the complex social, economic, and political factors that contributed to the emergence of the state. Nonetheless, it remains an important theory in the study of the origin of the state.

Mystical Theory of origin of State

The mystical theory of the origin of the state is one of the oldest theories that explains the origin of the state. According to this theory, the state is of divine origin and is created by God or gods. The ruler is considered to be the representative of God on earth and is therefore given the divine right to rule. The subjects are expected to obey the ruler as they would obey God.

Some key points of this theory are:

1. The state is of divine origin and is created by God or gods.
2. The ruler is considered to be the representative of God on earth and is therefore given the divine right to rule.
3. The subjects are expected to obey the ruler as they would obey God.
4. This theory is one of the oldest theories that explains the origin of the state.

This theory has been used to justify the rule of monarchs and emperors throughout history. However, it has been criticized for being unscientific and for not providing a rational explanation for the origin of the state. It is also considered to be outdated in modern times, where the legitimacy of the state is based on the consent of the governed rather than on divine right.

Contract Theory of origin of State

Contract theory is a theory that explains the origin of the state as a result of a social contract between individuals in a society. According to this theory, individuals in a society voluntarily give up some of their rights and freedoms to a governing body in exchange for protection and the enforcement of social order.

1. The theory is based on the idea that individuals have natural rights and freedoms that they are entitled to, but that living in a society requires some limitations on these rights in order to maintain social order and protect the rights of others.
2. The social contract is an agreement between individuals to form a government and abide by its rules in exchange for the benefits of living in a society with laws and protections.
3. The theory suggests that the state is formed as a result of this agreement and that its power and authority are derived from the consent of the governed.
4. The theory has been influential in the development of modern political thought and has been used to justify the existence of government and the need for individuals to obey its laws.
5. Some of the most well-known proponents of contract theory include Thomas Hobbes, John Locke, and Jean-Jacques Rousseau, each of whom had their own unique interpretation of the theory.

Stages of State Formation in Ancient India

The formation of the state in ancient India is linked with the growth and spread of agriculture, trade, industry, and urbanization. This process began with the spread of agriculture along river valleys, which generated an agricultural surplus that led to trade, commerce, and urbanization. The first states, known as Janapadas, emerged in these river valleys, and this pattern was replicated in the South and East .

According to ancient Indian texts, a kingdom (rajya) was constituted of seven elements (sapta-prakrtayah) or seven limbs (sapta-anga). These were the King (swamin), Minister (amatya), City (pura), Domain/territory (rastra), Treasury (kosa), Army (danda), and Ally (suhrd/mitra) .

In the course of the evolution of the state in Indian history, monarchies gradually conquered the republics in ancient India. Monarchies remained the mode of government in ancient, medieval, and modern India until the British Raj, without any revival of republicanism. The republican form could only be revived after India's Independence in 1947 .

The establishment of the Delhi Sultanate in 1206 AD changed the political landscape of northern India, with the strategically placed capital of Delhi becoming the new seat of central power. India's next imperial unification was under the Great Mughals, from Babur to Akbar (1526–1605 AD) .

Kingship in states in Ancient India

- Monarchy in ancient India was a sovereignty over a territory by a King who functioned as its protector, a role which involved both secular and religious power.
- The meaning and significance of kingship changed dramatically between the Vedic and Later Vedic period, and underwent further development under the times of the Jain and Buddhist rulers.
- The role of a King in ancient India has been emphasized vaguely in Vedic Literature. It has been considered that the Kingship was in most cases not elective.
- Ancient Indians believed that the Kingship arose out of military requirement.
- There were different theories of origin of kingship as well as the state in ancient Indian polity. According to one theory, the king was a subordinate to law, which was made by the society and not him. The community as a whole was given greater importance than the king.
- The ideology and symbolism of kingship have played an important role in Hinduism throughout its history, an influence that continues into the present day. The two great epic texts, the Mahābhārata and Rāmāyaṇa, are narratives of kingship, and the tensions and ambiguities inherent to the role of the king are fundamental to these texts.
- The study of kingship and its various related aspects are of tremendous importance in understanding the ancient Indian polity.

Council of Ministers in Ancient India

- The Council of Ministers, also known as **Mantri-parishad**, was a concept commonly known to the ancient Indian science of Society and Polity.
- It was defined in **Kauṭilya's Arthaśāstra** (4th century BCE), one of the most influential treatises of political science.

- The Council of Ministers was next in importance to the king.
- The Mauryas and the Sungas had a habitual council of ministers known as **Mantri-parishad**.
- The Saka rulers ruled with the assistance of a council of **mati sachivas** and **karma-sachivas**.
- The ministers under the Maukharis exercised great power.
- The council of ministers is variously designated as **Mantra** or **Mantri-parishad**, **Mantri-maṇḍala** and **Mantri-gaṇa**.
- The Prime Minister was known as **Mantrimukhya** or **Mahāmantri**.
- He was the leader of the cabinet, and the chief confidant of the king.
- He presided over the deliberations of the cabinet in the absence of the king.

Administration in Ancient India

- In the Indian Administrative System in ancient period, different systems of administration are found to have existed at different periods. The earliest reference can be traced to the Indus Valley civilization.
- From excavations, scholars have come to the conclusion that government in Mohenjodaro and Harappa was systematic.
- Ancient Indian political system goes back to about five thousand years or more.
- Administration was sufficiently developed. The head of administration was the king. To advise him in matters of the state and government, there used to be ministers and councillors.
- During the Mahabharata period the state has been called ‘Saptanghi’ and the principal form of government was monarchy.
- There were many small republics also in ancient India. These republics had some elements of democracy in their administration.
- The king (raja) was the supreme head of the legislative, executive and judiciary branches. He was assisted in administration by a number of officials.
- In ancient India big empires were divided into provinces and districts for the sake of administrative convenience, while small kingdoms like Pallavas, Vakatakas and Gahadawalas had only one type of division viz. the districts known by different names like vishaya or rashtra.

Political Ideals in Ancient India and their relevance in modern times

1. In ancient India, people led a democratic way of living although political democracy did not exist in its full form. Monarchy was also popular. After the sixth century, democratic organizations started declining. Kings and monarchs often remained engaged in wars .
2. Usanus, an ancient Indian philosopher, said that politics was the only science worth studying. People of ancient India considered the state and the government as basic instruments for the promotion of peaceful and

civilized life .

3. The book “Aspects of Political Ideas and Institutions in Ancient India” discusses different views on the origin and nature of the state in ancient India. It also deals with stages and processes of state formation and examines the relevance of caste and kin-based collectivities to the construction of polity .
4. In ancient India, the study of the Science of Politics was subordinated to that of Theology and Philosophical thought and had never developed as an independent branch of Knowledge. There existed an extensive literature on Dandaniti of Arthasastra prior to the time of Kautilya .
5. The King in Indian political thought was assigned with most important functions based on Vedic ideals to rule the people. Based on Vedic dharma, Yagnavalkya, Manu, Kautilya, and others developed a healthy political tradition for the progress and welfare of the people .

These political ideals and traditions from ancient India can still be relevant in modern times as they provide a framework for the promotion of peaceful and civilized life, the importance of the state and government, and the role of the ruler in the progress and welfare of the people.

Conditions’ of the Welfare of Societies in Ancient India

- In Ancient India, social change meant a shift in social structure. No society is fixed. It varies depending on the nature of the challenges it must address and the requirements it must meet .
- The idea of social welfare has been entrenched in the Indic civilization since ancient times in the concept of duty as opposed to rights .
- The welfare of the people was declared to be the chief concern of the State and it was the duty of all the officers and servants appointed by the King to work for the happiness and welfare of the people .
- Ancient texts explicitly provided for safeguard provisions for the weak and the needy .
- The Indic being a self-centric civilization, conceived welfare as a duty which the individual owed both to the self and to the society at large .
- It was this spiritual sense of duty through Dharma which made an individual feel obliged to perform one’s duties and work towards Kalyan and Mangal, which resembled the overall good of both the individual and the society .
- Discharging one’s duties in accordance with Dharma was considered as essential for the spiritual upliftment of an individual .
- This fine blend of duty along with spirituality formed the basis of social welfare, where we see the blossoming of an inward-looking civic society .
- So, consequently the social welfare activities carried out by the State (king) were understood as the duties or Dharma of the king rather than the rights of the subjects which could be demanded from the state .
- The evaluation of the performance of a king could hence be judged on the

basis of whether he had been successful in discharging the duties he owed towards his subjects and thus in fulfilling his Rajadharma .

- The Ashokan era could be argued to be one such example of a full-fledged welfare state of the Indic civilization .
- Ancient Indic literature is abound with instances where the fundamental duties of the kings (state) have been described at length .
- Through a description of the concept of social welfare of the ancient Indic era, including that followed by the state, the author seeks to argue that it would prove to be an excellent learning model for the present Indian state and its citizens because it emphasizes on one's duties rather than rights, which paves the way to the realization of one's social and spiritual upliftment, thus producing an overall elevation of the nation at large .

The Seven Limbs of the State in Ancient India

The Seven Limbs of the State, also known as the Saptanga Theory, was formulated by Kautilya in his work, the Arthashastra. According to this theory, a state has seven elements or constituents, namely:

1. **Swamin** - the King: The King is independent and his responsibility for peace, justice, and stability is stressed.
2. **Amatya** - the Minister or Bureaucrats: The Amatya is responsible for the administration of the state.
3. **Janapada** - the Land and the People or territory: The Janapada refers to the territory and the people of the state.
4. **Durga** - the Fortress or Fort: The Durga refers to the fortifications of the state.
5. **Kosha** - the Treasury or treasure: The Kosha refers to the treasury of the state.
6. **Danda** - the Army or coercive authority: The Danda refers to the coercive authority of the state.
7. **Mitra** - the Allies or ally: The Mitra refers to the allies of the state.

This entire set-up of the kingdom was described as the Saptanga theory in ancient India. The Saptanga theory categorically identified the ideal type qualities/excellencies of the state, determined whether a state would evolve into an inferior entity or a superior entity.

Society in Ancient India

- The Ancient Indian society was based upon **Varna and ashrams**, a four-fold classification of the entire people into varnas and a fourfold division of the life of each individuals into ashrams (stages).
- The Indo-Aryans were originally divided into three classes the **Brahman, Rajanya and Vis**.
- Ancient India societies had their distinctive **cultures, religions, indigenous beliefs, customs and occupations**. The customs, beliefs, prac-

tices, etc were quite different in the ancient Indian society.

- Ancient India witnessed the **evolution of different civilisations**.
- The inventions and innovations of the people of ancient India include many aspects of modern life taken for granted today including the **flush toilet, drainage and sewer systems, public pools, mathematics, veterinary science, plastic surgery, board games, yoga and meditation**, as well as many more.
- The ancient Indus systems of sewage and drainage developed and used in cities throughout the Indus region were far more advanced than any found in contemporary urban sites in the Middle East and even more efficient than those in many areas of Pakistan and India today.
- In the Indian empires from 600 BCE to 600 CE, emperors maintained and further developed social systems that had been in place for a long time.

Purusārtha in Society in Ancient India

Purusārtha is a fundamental principle of social ethics in ancient Indian society. It refers to the four proper goals or aims of a human life. These goals are not only meant to set an ideal objective but also to convey the right means to achieve them. The four Purusārthas are Dharma, Artha, Kama, and Moksha.

- **Dharma** refers to righteousness and moral values.
- **Artha** refers to prosperity and economic values.
- **Kama** refers to pleasure, love, and emotional fulfillment.
- **Moksha** refers to liberation and spiritual values.

These four goals were considered essential for leading a balanced and fulfilling life. Each goal was given importance in varying degrees, depending on the individual's stage in life and personal circumstances.

Varnāshrama System in Society in Ancient India

- The Varnāshrama system, also known as Varnashramadharma, developed in ancient Hindu society and refers to the segmental division of the Hindu society into four classes or varnas .
- The term 'Varnashramadharma' consists of three words - 'varna', 'asrama', and 'dharma' .
- The four varnas are Brahman, Kshatriya, Vaishya, and Sudra .
- Brahman is the class of the priests and teachers .
- Kshatriya is the class of the kings, warriors, and aristocrats .
- Vaishya is the class of traders, merchants, and people engaged in other professions .
- Sudra is the class of laborers and service providers .
- Ashrama is a system of stages of life discussed in Hindu texts of the ancient and medieval eras .
- The four ashramas are Brahmacharya (student), Grihastha (householder), Vanaprastha (forest walker/forest dweller), and Sannyasa (renunciate) .

Āshrama or the Stages of Life in Society in Ancient India

- Āśrama is a Sanskrit term that refers to a system of stages of life discussed in Hindu texts of the ancient and medieval eras.
- The four āśramas are:
 1. Brahmacharya (student)
 2. Gṛhastha (householder)
 3. Vanaprastha (forest walker/forest dweller)
 4. Sannyasa (renunciate).
- The Āśrama system is one facet of the Dharma concept in Hinduism.
- Ashrams are an outstanding feature of the social organization in ancient India. This system particularly developed during the later Vedic period.
- Liberally Ashram means halting place. But in the Indian social system, it implied stoppage or stage in the journey of life with a view to prepare one-self for further journey.
- Sannyasi, also spelled sannyasin, in Hinduism, is a religious ascetic who has renounced the world by performing his own funeral and abandoning all claims to social or family standing.
- Sannyasis, like other sadhus, or holy men, are not cremated but are generally buried in a seated posture of meditation.

Marriage in Society in Ancient India

- Marriage was regarded as a highly sacred institution in ancient Indian society.
- It involved the meeting of minds between spouses for material and psychological satisfaction.
- Marriage was a bond created between two families.
- Many scholars believe that the human race originally lived in a state of promiscuity, where individual marriage did not exist.
- In Hinduism, marriage is considered a sacrament between individuals of the same sex and gender.
- Marriage in Hinduism symbolizes diverse aspects of human nature: love, selflessness, trust, affection, and compassion.
- Kinship relations are often established through marriages.
- According to Manu Smriti, there existed eight main forms of Hindu marriages in ancient India: Brahma Vivah, Daiva Vivah, Arsha Vivah, Prajapatya Vivah, Gandharva Vivah, Asura Vivah, Rakshasa Vivah and Pisaka Vivah.

Understanding Gender as a social category in Society in Ancient India

- Gender roles in ancient India were greatly favored towards men. For instance, when a mother was going to give birth, everyone hoped that the baby would turn out to be a baby boy.

- However, women were considered with respect and dignity. During this period, there were women rishis, and they were held in high esteem.
- Gender Equality was one among many such values that was inculcated into the society and practiced as a norm. Almost all scholars today agree without a doubt that women in ancient India held an elevated position.
- Women were provided with the same level of education as men and could be a part of religious or philosophical debates.
- In ancient India, especially in the Indus valley civilization, women had a respectable position in society. In the early Vedic period, there was a plethora of opportunities for women.
- Women played a significant role in ancient India. The Rig Vedic Women in India enjoyed high status in society. Their condition was good. The women were provided the opportunity to attain high intellectual and spiritual standards. There were many women Rishis during this period.

The representation of Women in Historical traditions in Society in Ancient India

- A historical understanding of the status of women in early Indian society shows a declining trend in the position of women. Women did not share an equal position with men and were recognized only as wives and mothers.
- In the Indus Valley civilization, the worship of the mother goddess highlights the respect for women as mothers. Women were given equal honor along with men in society and enjoyed full freedom.
- Women in ancient India enjoyed high status in society and their condition was good. The ancient and medieval status of women in modern Indian society regarding equality, education, marriage, and family life, race and gender, religion, and culture is maintained or deteriorated.
- Classical Hindu laws focus almost exclusively on women as wives. Role models and norms for mothers, daughters, and sisters are more apt to appear in folklore and vernacular traditions. Furthermore, most written traditions emphasize women's behavior in relationship to men: wife/husband; mother/son; daughter/father; sister/brother.
- As a society, India has rooted its morality in myths and theology for hundreds of years and still has a long way to go towards the fair treatment of women today.
- The condition of women became worse off in the Gupta period. The Smritishastras abused them; Manusmriti dictated a woman would be dependent on her father in childhood, on her husband in youth, and on her son in old age. Apart from child marriage and sati, prostitution and the Devadasi system became widespread.

Challenges faced by Women in Society in Ancient India

- A historical understanding of the status of women in early Indian society shows a declining trend in the position of women. Women did not share an

equal position with men and were recognized only as wives and mothers. Their position was subordinate to men.

- Women in ancient India enjoyed high status in society and their condition was good. The Vedic women had economic freedom and some women were engaged in teaching work. Home was the place of production and women also helped their husbands in agricultural pursuit. In the religious field, wife enjoyed full rights and regularly participated in religious ceremonies with her husband. Women even participated actively in religious discourses.
- The status of women improved a little during the Buddhist period though there was no tremendous change. Ancient India had many learned ladies.
- The Medieval period (Period between 500 A.D to 1500 A.D) proved to be highly disappointing for the Indian women, for their status further deteriorated during this period. The Smritishastras abused them; Manu dictated a woman would be dependent on her father in childhood, on her husband in youth and on her son in old age. Apart from child marriage and sati, prostitution and Devadasi system became widespread.
- The problems of women and family life in ancient India were studied by some western orientalists too, such as, C. Bader and J. J. Meyer, who deeply admired the ideal of self-sacrificing Indian womanhood owing to their sense of disillusionment with the gross materialism of the industrial society.
- The Vedic dasi was also a part of ancient Indian society; however, she disappeared, leaving out any trace of herself in the Nineteenth-century history.

Four-class Classification of Society in Ancient India

The four-class classification of society in ancient India, also known as the caste system, was a strict social hierarchy imposed by Hinduism. The Vedas, ancient Indian texts, described four main social classes:

1. **Brahmins:** This class consisted of priests and scholars. Their task was to study and advise.
2. **Kshatriyas:** This class consisted of kings, governors, and warriors. Their task was to protect.
3. **Vaishyas:** This class consisted of cattle herders, agriculturists, artisans, and merchants. Their task was to cultivate.
4. **Shudras:** This class consisted of laborers and service providers. Their task was to serve.

The Dalit, formerly known as “untouchables,” were considered outside the system and were treated poorly.

This system helped in achieving greater vocational specialization and gave rise to the four classes of Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, and Shudras.

Slavery in Society in Ancient India

- When Megasthenes came to India in the 4th Century B.C., he found that slavery system was unknown to the Ancient Indian society. He declared all the Indians are free and that slaves do not exist in India.
- However, Megasthenes' observations about the non-existence of slavery in Ancient India are not supported by available evidences. From the Smritis and other Hindu Law Books, it is clear that slavery was a recognized institution in India in the Vedic Age. The Rig Veda mentions the non-Aryan enemies of the Aryans as Dasyu and Dasa.
- Slavery existed in ancient India, where it is recorded in the Sanskrit Laws of Manu of the 1st century BCE. The institution was little documented until the British colonials in the 19th century made it an object of study because of their desire to abolish it.
- Slavery and empire-formation tied in particularly well with iqta and it is within this context of Islamic expansion that elite slavery was later commonly found. It became the predominant system in North India in the thirteenth century and retained considerable importance in the fourteenth century.

Module 2- Indian Literature, Culture, Tradition, and Practices

1. Indian literature is one of the oldest in the world, with a rich tradition of poetry, drama, and storytelling.
2. The Vedas, the Mahabharata, and the Ramayana are some of the most famous works of Indian literature.
3. Indian culture is diverse and varied, with influences from many different regions and religions.
4. Some of the most important aspects of Indian culture include family values, respect for elders, and hospitality.
5. Indian traditions and practices are deeply rooted in the country's history and are often tied to religious beliefs.
6. Some of the most well-known Indian traditions include festivals such as Diwali and Holi, as well as practices such as yoga and meditation.
7. Indian cuisine is also an important part of the country's culture, with a wide variety of dishes and flavors.
8. Overall, Indian literature, culture, tradition, and practices are rich and diverse, reflecting the country's long history and unique identity.

Evolution of script in India

- The evolution of writing in India is well understood and all the modern scripts of India, for Indo-Aryan as well as Dravidian languages, as well as the scripts of Sri Lanka, Tibet, Southeast Asia, including the original scripts of Philippines and Indonesia, are derived from Brahmi.

- Due to differences in cultures and regions, the Brahmi script evolved into different types depending on the region.
- Greater emphasis on a quicker approach rather than the use of monumental inscriptions led to the emergence of cursive styles that formed India's modern script.
- Scripts in south India became rounded due to writing on palm leaves.
- The evolution of Brahmi into so many scripts over time in India raises the question of what individuals and scribes thought about the changes upon becoming aware of the fact that their contemporary writing systems were divergent in separate regions, and were also vastly different from the forms found in inscriptions and ancient documents.
- India has a long history of writing and has been a literate culture for millennia, but it has also greatly valued oral knowledge.

Evolution of languages in India

1. Throughout history, the evolution of Indian languages is a constant ebb and flow of influences and reconstruction from early proto-languages to the modern Indian languages.
2. The northern Indian languages from the Indo-Iranian family evolved from Old Indo-Aryan such as Sanskrit, by way of the Middle Indo-Aryan Prakrit languages and the Apabhramsha of the Middle Ages.
3. Hindi, Urdu, Tamil, Malayalam, Portuguese and English words pinballed around the globe in the 16th and 17th Centuries, revealing how languages evolve over time as culture is made and remade, and people adapt to conditions around them.
4. Since the Iron Age in India, the native languages of the Indian subcontinent are divided into various language families, of which the Indo-Aryan and the Dravidian are the most widely spoken. There are also many languages belonging to unrelated language families such as Austroasiatic and Sino-Tibetan, spoken by smaller groups.

Harappan Script

- The Harappan Script, also known as the Indus Script, is a corpus of symbols produced by the Indus Valley Civilization .
- Most inscriptions containing these symbols are extremely short, making it difficult to judge whether or not they constituted a writing system used to record the as-yet unidentified language(s) of the Indus Valley Civilization .
- The script found in the Indus Valley from Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro is the oldest known script of India. Unfortunately, till now it has not been read satisfactorily. This has made the problem of the Indus Valley script even more intractable .
- The Harappan script has long defied attempts to read it, and therefore the language remains unknown .

- The Indus Script combined both word signs and symbols with phonetic value. This type of writing system is known as “logo-syllabic”, where some symbols express ideas or words while others represent sounds. This view is based on the fact that roughly 400 signs have been identified, which makes it unlikely that the Indus Script was solely phonetic .

Brahmi Script

- The Brahmi script is the earliest writing system developed in India after the Indus script.
- It is one of the most influential writing systems; all modern Indian scripts and several hundred scripts found in Southeast and East Asia are derived from Brahmi.
- The Brahmi writing system, or script, appeared as a fully developed universal one in South Asia in the third century BCE.
- It is a forerunner of all writing systems that have found use in South Asia with the exception of the Indus script of the third millennium BCE, the Kharosthi script, which originated in what today is northwestern Pakistan in the fourth or possibly fifth century BCE, the Perso-Arabic Scripts of the medieval period, and the Latin scripts of the modern period.
- The Brahmi script is mentioned in the ancient Indian texts of Hinduism, Jainism and Buddhism, as well as their Chinese translations.
- For example, the Lipisala samdarshana parivarta lists 64 lipi (scripts), with the Brahmi script starting the list.
- Its descendants, the Brahmic scripts, continue to be used today across South and Southeast Asia.
- The Brahmi script was already divided into regional variants at the time of the earliest surviving epigraphy around the 3rd century BC.
- Cursives of the Brahmi script began to diversify further from around the 5th century AD and continued to give rise to new scripts throughout the Middle Ages.
- The Brāhmī alphabet is the ancestor of most of the 40 or so modern Indian alphabets Khmer and Tibetan.
- It is thought to have been modelled on the Aramaic or Phoenician alphabets, and appeared in India sometime before 500 BC.
- Another theory is that Brāhmī developed from the Indus or Harappa script, which was used in the Indus valley until

The Vedas

- The Vedas are a large body of religious texts originating in ancient India.
- Composed in Vedic Sanskrit, the texts constitute the oldest layer of Sanskrit literature and the oldest scriptures of Hinduism .
- There are four Vedas: the Rigveda, the Yajurveda, the Samaveda, and the Atharvaveda .
- The term “veda” means “knowledge” and they are thought to contain the

fundamental knowledge relating to the underlying cause of, function of, and personal response to existence .

- The Vedas inform the religion of Hinduism, also known as Sanatan Dharma meaning “Eternal Order” or “Eternal Path” .
- The word Veda means wisdom, knowledge, or vision, and it serves to manifest the language of the gods in human speech .
- The laws of the Vedas have regulated the social, legal, domestic, and religious customs of Hindus up to the present day .
- All the obligatory duties of Hindus at birth, marriage, death, etc. are guided by Vedic rituals .

The Upanishads

- The Upanishads are late Vedic Sanskrit texts that supplied the basis of later Hindu philosophy.
- They are commonly referred to as Vedānta.
- Vedanta has been interpreted as the “last chapters, parts of the Veda” and alternatively as “object, the highest purpose of the Veda”.
- The aim of all Upanishads is to investigate the nature of Ātman (self), and “direct [ing] the enquirer toward it”.
- There are more than 200 known Upanishads, one of which, the Muktikā Upanishad, predates 1656 CE and contains a list of 108 canonical Upanishads, including itself as the last.
- These are further divided into Upanishads associated with Shaktism (goddess Shakti), Sannyasa (renunciation, monastic life), Shaivism (god Shiva), Vaishnavism (god Vishnu).
- The Upanishads are the philosophical-religious texts of Hinduism (also known as Sanatan Dharma meaning “Eternal Order” or “Eternal Path”) which develop and explain the fundamental tenets of the religion.
- The name is translated as to “sit down closely” as one would to listen attentively to instruction by a teacher or other authority figure.
- The Upanishads present a vision of an interconnected universe with a single, unifying principle behind the apparent diversity in the cosmos, any articulation of which is called brahman.
- Within this context, the Upanishads teach that brahman resides in the atman, the unchanging core of the human individual.

The Ramayana

- The Ramayana is an ancient Indian epic, composed some time in the 5th century BCE, about the exile and then return of Rama, prince of Ayodhya.
- It was composed in Sanskrit by the sage Valmiki, who taught it to Rama’s sons, the twins Lava and Kush.
- At about 24000 verses, it is a rather long poem and, by tradition, is known as the Adi Kavya (adi means original or first; kavya means poem).
- The Ramayana belongs to the genre of Itihasa, narratives of past events

(purāvṛtta), which includes the Mahabharata, the Puranas, and the Ramayana. The genre also includes teachings on the goals of human life.

- The Ramayana was an important influence on later Sanskrit poetry and the Hindu life and culture, and its main characters were fundamental to the cultural consciousness of a number of nations, both Hindu and Buddhist.

The Mahabharata

- The Mahabharata is one of the two great Sanskrit epics of the Hindus, existing in its present form since c.
- It is one of the two Sanskrit epic poems of ancient India (the other being the Ramayana).
- The Mahabharata is an exposition of dharma (codes of conduct), including the proper conduct of a king, of a warrior, of an individual living in times of calamity, and of a person seeking to attain moksha (freedom from samsara, or rebirth).
- It is an important source of information on the development of Hinduism between 400 BCE and 200 CE and is regarded by Hindus as both a text about dharma (Hindu moral law) and a history.

Puranas

- Puranas are a vast genre of Indian literature about a wide range of topics, particularly about legends and other traditional lore .
- The word “Purana” means “ancient” or “old” in Sanskrit .
- Puranas are considered one of the most ancient Indian literature about Hinduism and are post-Vedic Texts .
- They are regarded as the fifth Veda .
- The Puranas are known for the intricate layers of symbolism depicted within their stories .
- They were composed originally in Sanskrit verse, and their composition dates from the 4th century BCE to about 1,000 A.D .
- Puranas are popular encyclopedic collections of myth, legend, and genealogy, varying greatly as to date and origin .
- They were written almost entirely in narrative couplets, in much the same easy flowing style as the two great Sanskrit epic poems, the Mahabharata and the Ramayana .
- The Puranas are ancient Hindu texts eulogizing various deities of the Hindu pantheon through divine stories .
- They can be categorized under the same class as the ‘Itihasas’ or Histories - the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, and are believed to have been derived from the same religious system as these epics .

Buddhist Literature in Pali, Prakrit And Sanskrit

- The first Buddhist works were written in **Pali**, the language spoken in Magadha and South Bihar. It is said that Lord Buddha delivered his

sermons in Pali, and they have been recorded in the same language .

- **Prakrit** is a catch-all name for any language that differs from the mainstream one, **Sanskrit**. Pali is an old Prakrit dialect that combines several dialects .
- The Buddhist literary and Philosophical works are in **Pali and Sanskrit** while the Jaina records are in **Prakrit and Sanskrit** .
- The prosodic variety of Buddhist lyrics is great; about **30 different metres** can be distinguished. Pāli poems, with their new metres (often based on a musical phrase), stylistic features, figures of speech, and choice diction, foreshadow classical kāvya literature in Sanskrit, whose extant specimens date from a later period .
- The best known of this group is **Pali**, which still serves as the canonical language of Buddhism in Sri Lanka and Southeast Asia. Other Prakrit languages such as Sauraseni, Maharastri, Magadhi and Gandhari embody various facets of the literatures of both the Brahmanical/Hindu and Buddhist traditions .

Jain Literature in Pali,Prakrit And Sanskrit

- Jain literature refers to the literature of the Jain religion. It is a vast and ancient literary tradition, which was initially transmitted orally .
- The oldest surviving material is contained in the canonical Jain Agamas, which are written in Ardhamagadhi, a Prakrit (Middle-Indo Aryan) language .
- Early Jain literature is mostly written in Prakrit language. Prakrit language was a form of Sanskrit language .
- Pali language was a form of Prakrit language which was used in Magadha .
- Pali and Prakrit were the first languages to emerge from Sanskrit. Pali was used for the dissemination of Buddhist ideas, whereas Prakrit was used for the dissemination of Jain doctrines .
- The majority of Buddhist literature is written in Pali, while Jain literature is written in Prakrit .

Kautilya's Arthashastra

- The Arthashastra refers to a practice of political diplomacy that emerged in India, and is epitomized by the written material on position, policy, and military strategy written by Kautilya.
- Kautilya was a professor at Taxila University and later the Mauryan Empire's Prime Minister.
- The Arthashastra is an Indian treatise on politics, economics, military strategy, the function of the state, and social organization attributed to the philosopher and Prime Minister Kautilya (also known as Chanakya, Vishnugupta, l. c. 350-275 BCE) who was instrumental in establishing the reign of the great king Chandragupta Maurya (r. c. 321-c.297 BCE),

founder of the Mauryan Empire (322-185 BCE).

- Artha-shastra, (Sanskrit: “The Science of Material Gain”) also spelled Artha-śāstra, is a singularly important Indian manual on the art of politics, attributed to Kautilya (also known as Chanakya), who reportedly was chief minister to the emperor Chandragupta (c. 300 bce), the founder of the Mauryan dynasty.
- Kautilya’s Arthashastra depicts a bureaucratic welfare state, in fact, some kind of socialized monarchy, in which the central government administers the details of the economy for the common good. In addition, Kautilya offers a work of genius in matters of foreign policy and welfare, including key principles of international relations from a realist perspective.

Famous Sanskrit Authors in India

1. **Kalidasa:** Considered to be the greatest Sanskrit language poet in India, Kalidasa is widely said to have been from the 5th-century, though most details of his life are subject to speculation. He was arguably one of ancient India’s greatest Sanskrit dramatists. Three famous romantic plays written by Kālidāsa are the Mālavikāgnimitram (Mālavikā and Agnimitra), Vikramōrva.
2. **Bhasa:** One of the greatest pioneers of classical Sanskrit drama, Bhasa is said to have lived around 3rd Century A.D. He is one of the earliest known Sanskrit dramatists of ancient India. An Indian scholar, Mahamahopadhyaya Ganapati Sastrigal, rediscovered thirteen of his plays in the year 1912.
3. **Gajapati Purusottama Deva:** Gajapati Purusottama Deva (1497 A.D.) the son of Gajapati Kapilendra Deva, was a great conqueror and a reputed scholar like his father. The authorship of the works, namely Muktichintamani, Gopalarchana vidhi, Nama Malika, Durogotsava and Bhubaneswari Pujapallava, have been attributed to Gajapati Purusottama Deva.
4. **Satyavrat Shastri:** In 2009, Satyavrat Shastri became the first Sanskrit author to win the Jnanpith Award, India’s highest literary award.
5. **Vidyadhar Shastri:** Vidyadhar Shastri wrote two epic poems (Mahakavya), seven shorter poems, three plays and three songs of praise (stavana kavya). He received the Vidyavachaspati award in 1962.
6. **Bharavi:** Bharavi is a Sanskrit poet known for his Mahakavya, Kiratarjuniya.
7. **Bhartṛhari:** Bhartṛhari is a Sanskrit writer to whom are normally ascribed two influential Sanskrit texts: the Vākyapadiya, on Sanskrit grammar and linguistic philosophy, and the Śatakatraya, a work of Sanskrit poetry.

8. **Bhāsa:** Bhāsa is one of the earliest and most celebrated Indian playwrights in Sanskrit, predating Kalidasa.
9. **Bhatta Narayana:** Bhatta Narayana is a Sanskrit poet and dramatist, author of the play Venisamhara.
10. **Budhasvamin:** Budhasvamin is the author of the Brhatkatha, a collection of stories in Sanskrit.
11. **Banabhatta:** Banabhatta was a Sanskrit prose writer and poet of early medieval India.

Telugu Literature

- Telugu literature is the body of works written in the Telugu language. It consists of poems, short stories, novels, plays, and song lyrics, among others .
- Telugu is a Dravidian language spoken in an area north of Madras, India, and running inland to Bellary .
- The literature, beginning in the 10th or 11th century, is mainly poetry and secular and religious epics, with the śataka (“century” of verses) as a very popular form .
- Telugu literature is divided into six ages, starting from the Pre-Nannayan period to the modern age. During the Pre-Nannayan period, only inscriptions were present till 575 A.D. However, in the 11th century A.D., Nannayya Bhattaraka translated the Sanskrit Mahabharata into Telugu. This has revolutionized Telugu literature .

Kannada Literature

- Kannada literature is the corpus of written forms of the Kannada language, a member of the Dravidian family spoken mainly in the Indian state of Karnataka and written in the Kannada script.
- The topics of Kannada literature included grammar, philosophy, prosody, rhetoric, chronicles, biography, history, drama and cuisine, as well as dictionaries and encyclopedias.
- According to critic Joseph T. Shipley, over fifty works on scientific subjects including medicine, mathematics and astrology have been written in the Kannada language.
- The earliest records in Kannada are inscriptions dating from the 6th century AD onward.
- Modern Kannada literature refers to the body of literature written in the Kannada language.

Malayalam Literature

- Malayalam literature comprises those literary texts written in Malayalam, a South-Dravidian language spoken in the Indian state of Kerala.

- The first travelogue in any Indian language is the Malayalam Varthamanappusthakam, written by Paremmakkal Thoma Kathanar in 1785.
- The earliest extant literary work is Ramacharitam (late 12th or early 13th century).
- The earliest examples of Malayalam literature are ballads and folk songs, which are entirely indigenous.
- Two outside sources, however, contributed much to the development of the later literature: Sanskrit, which was the language of scholarship, and Tamil, which was the language of administration over a long period.
- In the subsequent period, besides a popular pattu (song) literature, there flourished a literature of mainly erotic poetry composed in the Manipravalam style, an admixture of Malayalam and Sanskrit.

Sangama Literature in India

- Sangama literature, also spelled as Cankam, Chankam, or Shangam, is the earliest known writings in the Tamil language.
- It is thought to have been produced in three literary academies, or Chankams, in Madurai, India, from the 1st to the 4th century CE .
- Sangama literature is possibly unique in early Indian literature, which is almost entirely religious .
- The poems are concerned with two main topics: those of the first five collections are on love (akam), and those of the next two are on heroism (puram), including the praise of kings and their deeds .
- Sangama literature is often known as “the poetry of the noble ones” and is South India’s earliest known literature .
- Sangama literature is broadly classified into akam (inner) and puram (outer) .
- The akam poetry is about emotions and feelings in the context of romantic love, sexual union, and eroticism .
- The puram poetry is about exploits and heroic deeds in the context of war and public life .

Northern Indian languages

- Northern India is home to several Indo-Aryan languages.
- The Hindustani lingua franca, which includes both Hindi and Urdu, is native to Northern India.
- There is also an extensive range of western and eastern Hindi dialects.
- Bihari languages, including Bhojpuri, Magadhi, and Maithili, are also spoken in the region.
- Punjabi, Pahari languages, and Kashmiri are other examples of Northern Indian languages.
- The historical evolution of these languages is not well defined, and there is no consensus on when the modern North Indian languages emerged.

- These languages have assimilated various aboriginal instances .

North Indian Literature

- North Indian literature is derived from the ancient Indian background, which includes two Sanskrit epic poems, the Mahabharata and Ramayana, as well as the Bhagavata-purana and the other Puranas.
- North India was the birthplace of Kalidasa, who wrote classic Sanskrit plays like *Mālavikāgnimitram*, *Abhijñānaśākuntalam* and *Vikramōrvaśīyam* and poems like *Raghuvamśa*, *Kumārasambhava*, *Ṛtusaṃhāra* and *Meghadūta* in which the use of imagination and similes remains unequaled by any other literary work.
- Northeast India's literature is representative of varied histories, languages, socio-cultural and religious practices due to its rich cultural and ethnolinguistic diversity.
- Mizo folk literature comes from the Northeastern state of India called Mizoram. The Mizos are well known as “the singing tribe.” This compilation includes folk narratives, songs, proverbs, rituals, riddles, tales, and war cries.

Persian Literature in India

- Persian literature has had a significant impact on the Indian subcontinent, particularly during the medieval period.
- Persian was the official language of most Muslim dynasties in the Indian subcontinent, such as the Delhi Sultanate, the Bengal Sultanate, the Bahmani Sultanate, the Mughal Empire and their successor states, and the Sikh Empire.
- Persian was also the dominant cultured language of poetry and literature.
- Persian literature mostly came from outside the court, such as the works of Sufism and the “popular literature” created by Bengali Muslims.
- In the 16th century, the Bengal region came under the Mughals to form the Bengal Subah, and in this era Persian's impact was much more profound.
- Persian literary sources of medieval India reflect thought, social structure, culture, political institutions of that time or the spirit of the age.
- Persian was the favorite language of rulers the, Delhi Sultanate and Mughals promoted it. That was the time when Persian poetry, literature and chronicles enjoyed patronage.
- A new epic in the history of Persian literature in India started under Balban. Balban's eldest son Muhammad (also known as Khan i-Shahid) was also a patron of learning and many eminent poets lived at his court, the famous Persian poets Amir Khusrau and Mir Hassan Dehlvi started their poetic career under him.
- Persian is also known as Farsi and originally belongs to Southwestern Iran, having grammatical similarities with the European Languages. Persian was appointed as the language of administration by Babur.

Urdu Literature in India

- Urdu literature refers to writings in the Urdu language of the Muslims of Pakistan and northern India.
- It is written in the Perso-Arabic script.
- With a few major exceptions, the literature is the work of Muslim writers who take their themes from the life of the Indian subcontinent.
- Urdu literature is a vast field of immense knowledge and rich literary works by famous poets and writers.
- Though Hindi and Urdu have the same root, they have developed and evolved on distinct lines.
- Urdu literature tends to be dominated by poetry, especially the verse forms of the ghazal and nazm, but it has expanded into other styles of writing, including that of the short story, or afsana.

Hindi Literature

- Hindi literature includes literature in the various Hindi language which have writing systems.
- Earliest forms of Hindi literature are attested in poetry of Apabhramṣa like Awadhi, Magadhi, Ardhamagadhi and Marwari languages.
- The origins of Hindi literature is deeply rooted in the Indo-Aryan language called Awadhi and traces its way back to the 11th Century.
- The themes of Hindi literature are majorly comprised of religion and philosophy along with folk stories of the Indian continent. These genres have taken various shapes owing to changing times and issues.
- Hindi literature is divided into four stages viz., Adikal, Bhaktikal, Ritikal and Adhunikkal.
- Between the middle of the 10th century and the beginning of the 14th century, known as Adhikal, Hindi literature was mainly in the form of poetry.

Module 3- Indian Religion, Philosophy, and Practices

1. India is a country with a diverse range of religious beliefs and practices.
2. Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Sikhism are four major religions that originated in India.
3. Hinduism is the oldest and the most widely practiced religion in India. It is a complex religion with no single founder or scripture.
4. Buddhism was founded by Siddhartha Gautama, also known as the Buddha, in the 5th century BCE. It teaches the path to enlightenment through the Four Noble Truths and the Eightfold Path.
5. Jainism was founded by Mahavira in the 6th century BCE. It teaches the path to liberation through non-violence, truthfulness, non-stealing, chastity, and non-possessiveness.
6. Sikhism was founded by Guru Nanak in the 15th century. It teaches the belief in one God and the importance of living a truthful and honest life.

7. Apart from these four major religions, there are also many other religions practiced in India, including Islam, Christianity, Zoroastrianism, Judaism, and the Bahá'í Faith.
8. Indian philosophy includes six orthodox schools of Hindu philosophy, namely Samkhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Mimamsa, and Vedanta, as well as several heterodox schools such as Buddhism and Jainism.
9. Indian religious practices include rituals, festivals, and pilgrimages. Some of the major festivals celebrated in India include Diwali, Holi, Eid al-Fitr, Christmas, and Vaisakhi.
10. Yoga and meditation are also important practices in Indian religion and philosophy, with their origins in ancient Indian traditions.

Pre-Vedic Religion in India

- Pre-Vedic religion refers to the religious beliefs and practices that existed in India before the arrival of the Aryans and the composition of the Vedas.
- The early Dravidian religion constituted a non-Vedic form of Hinduism in that they were either historically or are at present Āgamic. The Agamas are non-Vedic in origin, and have been dated either as post-Vedic texts, or as pre-Vedic compositions .
- The Indus Valley Civilization, also known as the Harappan Civilization, is considered to be a pre-Vedic civilization .
- The nature of the religious beliefs and practices of the Aryans is known from the Rig Veda. They believed in many gods like Indra, Varuna, Agni, Surya, and Rudra .
- Vedism, also called Vedic religion, is the religion of the ancient Indo-European-speaking peoples who entered India about 1500 BCE from the region of present-day Iran. It takes its name from the collections of sacred texts known as the Vedas .
- Vedism is the oldest stratum of religious activity in India for which there exist written materials .

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- The Vedic religion refers to the religious beliefs of some Vedic Indo-Aryan tribes, the aryaas, who migrated into the Indus River valley region of the Indian subcontinent after the collapse of the Indus Valley Civilisation .
- The historical Vedic religion constituted the religious ideas and practices among some of the Indo-Aryan peoples of the northwest Indian subcon-

tinent (Punjab and the western Ganges plain) during the Vedic period (1500–500 BCE) .

- It is also known as Vedicism, Vedism or ancient Hinduism and subsequently Brahmanism or Brahminism .

Buddhism in India

- Buddhism started in India over 2,600 years ago as a way of life that had the potential of transforming a person.
- It is one of the important religions of South and South-Eastern Asian countries.
- The religion is based upon the teachings and life experiences of its founder Siddhartha Gautam, born in circa 563 BCE.
- During its first century of existence, Buddhism spread from its place of origin in Magadha and Kosala throughout much of northern India, including the areas of Mathura and Ujjayani in the west.
- Buddhism spread outside of Magadha starting in the Buddha's lifetime.
- Mahākāśyapa, a disciple of the Buddha, presided over the first Buddhist council held at Rājagṛha.
- The Second Buddhist Council is said to have taken place at Vaiśālī.
- India is organising an international conference on 'shared Buddhist heritage' to focus on the country's civilisational connect with the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO) nations.
- Indian Buddhism, having become primarily a monastic movement, seems to have lost touch with its lay supporters.
- Many monasteries had become very wealthy, so much so that they were able to employ indentured slaves and paid labourers to care for the monks and to tend the lands they owned.

Jainism in India

- Jainism, also known as Jain Dharma, is an Indian religion .
- It is one of the three most ancient religions of India, with roots that go back to at least the mid-first century B.C.E .
- The spiritual goal of Jainism is to become liberated from the endless cycle of rebirth and to achieve an all-knowing state called moksha .
- Jainism teaches that the path to enlightenment is through nonviolence and reducing harm to living things (including plants and animals) as much as possible .
- Jains are the only religious group in India where a majority say they are members of a higher General Category caste .
- On January 20, 2014, the Government of India awarded the minority status to the Jain community in India .
- Along with Hinduism and Buddhism, Jainism is one of the three most ancient Indian religious traditions still in existence and an integral part of South Asian religious .

Six System Indian Philosophy

The Six Systems of Indian Philosophy are philosophical traditions that originated in the Indian subcontinent. These systems are:

1. **Nyaya:** Founded by Akshapada Gautama, Nyaya is a school that deals with logic and epistemology. It is known for its analysis of logic and its means of knowledge known as inference .
2. **Vaisheshika:** Popularly understood as the atomistic school of Indian Philosophy.
3. **Samkhya:** An extremely complex school of philosophy that goes deep into the understanding of the creator and the creation.
4. **Yoga:** Also known as Ashtanga Yoga.
5. **Purva Mimamsa:** One of the six systems of Indian Philosophy.
6. **Uttara Mimamsa or Vedanta:** The term Vedanta means the “conclusion” of the Vedas, the earliest sacred literature of India. It applies to the Upanishads, which were elaborations of the Vedas, and to the school that arose out of the study of the Upanishads.

Each of these systems differs in one way or the other in terms of its concepts, phenomena, laws, and dogmas.

Shankaracharya and Advaita Vedanta

- Adi Shankara was an Indian philosopher and theologian who expounded the doctrine of Advaita Vedanta.
- He renounced the worldly pleasures at a very young age.
- Shankaracharya amalgamated the ideologies of ancient ‘Advaita Vedanta’ and also explained the basic ideas of Upanishads.
- He is the most renowned exponent of the Advaita Vedanta school of philosophy, from whose doctrines the main currents of modern Indian thought are derived.
- He established mathas, which are thought to have aided in the historical growth, renewal, and dissemination of his philosophy.
- Śaṅkara is one of the most widely known and influential Indian philosophers from the classical period, and the most authoritative philosopher of Advaita Vedānta.
- The cultural influence of Shankara and Advaita Vedanta started only centuries later, in the Vijayanagara Empire in the 14th century, when Sringeri matha started to receive patronage from the kings of the Vijayanagara Empire and became a powerful institution.

Various Philosophical Doctrines in India

Indian philosophy refers to the systems of thought and reflection that were developed by the civilizations of the Indian subcontinent. These include both orthodox (astika) systems and unorthodox (nastika) systems. The orthodox systems are the Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Purva-Mimamsa (or Mimamsa),

and Vedanta schools of philosophy, while the unorthodox systems include Buddhism and Jainism .

Indian philosophy is characterized by its acceptance of the authority of ancient philosophers, with innovations being represented as extensions of older systems of thought. It is also characterized by its flexibility and tendency to synthesize . Indian schools generally embody the doctrines of karma and rebirth, with the belief that man must be perfected before he can achieve salvation .

Indian thought has been concerned with various philosophical problems, including the nature of the world (cosmology), the nature of reality (metaphysics), logic, the nature of knowledge (epistemology), ethics, and the philosophy of religion . Indian philosophies share many concepts such as dharma, karma, samsara, reincarnation, dukkha, renunciation, and meditation, with almost all of them focusing on the ultimate goal of liberation of the individual through a diverse range of spiritual practices (moksha, nirvana) .

Heterodox Sects in India

Heterodox sects refer to the various religious groups and movements that emerged in India as a response to the ritual-ridden religion of the Vedic period. These sects were founded by ascetic wanderers and teachers who attracted groups of followers and established their own philosophies, which encompassed antinomian, materialist, and fatalist elements.

Some of the major heterodox sects that emerged in India include:

1. **Jainism:** Founded by Mahavira, the 24th Tirthankara, in 540 BC. Jainism is an ancient Indian religion that teaches the path to liberation and bliss is to live a life of harmlessness and renunciation.
2. **Ājīvika:** A nāstika or “heterodox” school of Indian philosophy believed to be founded in the 5th century BCE by Makkhali Gosāla. It was a Śramaṇa movement and a major rival of Vedic religion, early Buddhism, and Jainism.
3. **Cārvāka:** Also known as Materialism, this philosophical movement condemned the Vedas as ‘a pious fraud’. The Cārvākas believed in the materialistic view of life and rejected the existence of an afterlife, the soul, and the supernatural.

These are just a few examples of the many heterodox sects that emerged in India. These sects challenged the orthodox beliefs and practices of the time and offered alternative paths to spiritual enlightenment.

Bhakti Movement in India

- The Bhakti movement was a significant religious movement in medieval Hinduism that sought to bring religious reforms to all strata of society by adopting the method of devotion to achieve salvation.

- Bhakti movement in Hinduism refers to ideas and engagement that emerged in the medieval era on love and devotion to religious concepts built around one or more gods and goddesses.
- Bhakti movement preached against the caste system using the local languages so that the message reached the masses. One who practices bhakti is called a bhakta.
- The Bhakti movement, believed to have originated in Tamil Nadu sometime around the 7th and 8th centuries was a cultural, social and religious revolution, the ramifications of which are felt to this day as the movement gained impetus, galvanised the nation in waves and manifested its influence in India's freedom struggle.
- Bhakti, (Sanskrit: "devotion") in Hinduism, is a movement emphasizing the mutual intense emotional attachment and love of a devotee toward a personal god and of the god for the devotee. According to the Bhagavadgita, a Hindu religious text, the path of bhakti, or bhakti-marga, is superior to the two other religious approaches, the path of
- The Bhakti movement was a trend that took place in the faith of Hinduism during medieval times, specifically, around the time of the late seventh century up until the seventeenth century.

Sufi movement in India

- The Sufi movement was a socio-religious movement that took place in the Indian subcontinent during the fourteenth to sixteenth century.
- The exponents of this movement were unorthodox Muslim saints who had a deep study of Vedantic philosophy and Buddhism of India.
- They had gone through various religious texts of India and had come in contact with great sages and seers of India.
- Sufism has a history in India evolving for over 1,000 years.
- The presence of Sufism has been a leading entity increasing the reaches of Islam throughout South Asia.
- Following the entrance of Islam in the early 8th century, Sufi mystic traditions became more visible during the 10th and 11th centuries of the Delhi Sultanate.
- In India, the Sufi movement began in 1300 A.D. and spread to South India during the 15th century.
- At the onset of 12 A.D., few holy people in Persia turned to austerity due to the rising materialism of the Caliphate. They were called 'Sufis'.

Socio-religious reform movement of 19th century in India

- The 19th century was a period of transition and contestation in the socio-religious sphere in India.
- The main reason for the emergence of the reform movements was the spread of western education and liberal ideas.
- These reforms started in Bengal and soon spread to all parts of India.

- The Indian society in the first half of the 19th century was caste-ridden, decadent, and rigid.
- The social and religious reform in North India was spearheaded by Swami Dayanand Saraswati (1824-1883) who founded the Arya Samaj in 1875.
- The Arya Samaj strove against idolatry, polytheism, rituals, priesthood, animal sacrifice, child marriage, and the caste system.
- The Arya Samaj also encouraged the dissemination of western scientific knowledge.

Modern religious practices in India

- India is a secular country with a diverse population practicing various religions.
- According to the 2011 census, 79.8% of the population of India practices Hinduism, 14.2% adheres to Islam, 2.3% adheres to Christianity, 1.7% adheres to Sikhism, 0.7% adheres to Buddhism and 0.4% adheres to Jainism .
- Zoroastrianism, Sanamahism and Judaism also have an ancient history in India, and each has several thousands of Indian adherents .
- Religion still plays a significant role in the lives of most Indians .
- India's religious groups share several religious practices and beliefs .
- After living side by side for generations, India's minority groups often engage in practices or hold beliefs that are more closely associated with Hindu traditions than with their own .

Module 4-Science, Management and Indian Knowledge System

1. Science and Management: Science and management are two distinct fields of study, but they are closely related. Science is the systematic study of the natural world, while management is the art of planning, organizing, leading, and controlling resources to achieve specific goals. Both fields rely on data, analysis, and critical thinking to make informed decisions.
2. Indian Knowledge System: The Indian knowledge system is a rich and diverse tradition that encompasses a wide range of disciplines, including philosophy, mathematics, astronomy, medicine, and the arts. This system is based on the belief that knowledge is not just a means to an end, but an end in itself, and that the pursuit of knowledge is a noble and fulfilling endeavor.
3. Science and Indian Knowledge System: The Indian knowledge system has made significant contributions to the field of science. For example, the concept of zero, the decimal system, and the use of algebra were all developed in India. In addition, ancient Indian texts contain detailed

descriptions of surgical procedures, the use of medicinal plants, and the principles of hygiene and sanitation.

4. Management and Indian Knowledge System: The Indian knowledge system also has much to offer the field of management. For example, the principles of dharma (righteousness), artha (material wealth), kama (pleasure), and moksha (liberation) provide a framework for ethical decision-making and the pursuit of a balanced and fulfilling life. In addition, ancient Indian texts such as the Arthashastra and the Mahabharata contain valuable insights into leadership, strategy, and governance.
5. Conclusion: In conclusion, science, management, and the Indian knowledge system are all interconnected and have much to offer one another. By drawing on the strengths of each, we can develop a more holistic and integrated approach to understanding and managing the world around us.

Astronomy in India and Ancient India

- Astronomy in ancient India can be divided into two major classes. From the third-century BCE, India started having contact with Greece and other nations outside the subcontinent. So, the basic structure of Indian astronomy had outside influence although the astronomical concepts and the major parameters were India's own.
- Astronomy in ancient India developed to a sophisticated level (to the extent possible, of course) as the sages of ancient India were keen observers of the sky generation after generation.
- The earliest references to astronomy are found in the Rig Veda, which are dated 2000 BC.
- Astronomy has a long history in the Indian subcontinent stretching from pre-historic to modern times. Some of the earliest roots of Indian astronomy can be dated to the period of Indus Valley civilization or earlier. Astronomy later developed as a discipline of Vedanga, or one of the "auxiliary disciplines" associated with the study of the Vedas.
- One of the most accomplished of the ancient Indian astronomers was Brahmagupta, who was born in 598 and died around 665. He had a profound and direct influence on Islamic and Byzantine astronomy.

Chemistry in India and Ancient India

- In ancient India, chemistry was called **Rasayana** in Sanskrit, the language in vogue. Rasayana derived its name from **Rasa**, which means **extract**, maybe from roots, leaves, and stems of plants .
- India has a very ancient tradition of chemistry. In ancient texts, amazing information is available on metals, ores, their quarries, compounds, and alloys. There are also details of hundreds of devices used in chemical experiments in **Rasayan Shastra** which we call **chemistry**.

- Chemical techniques in India can be traced back all the way to the **Indus valley or Harappan civilization** (3rd millennium BCE).
- Ancient India's development in chemistry was not confined but found development in a variety of practical activities.

Mathematics in India and Ancient India

- In ancient India, mathematics or 'Ganita' was the 'Science of Calculations'. It was primarily studied in the context of numerical computation and geometric measurement.
- Most of the Indian mathematical work can be found as a part of 'Jyotisha' or Astronomy.
- The history of Indian mathematics dates back to the vedic period (around 1500 B.C.).
- Mathematics in ancient India was so well developed that the body of knowledge was not restricted only to the elite scholars. It was prevalently used even by the common people in their daily activities and profession.
- The origin of the ancient mathematics can be traced to the Indus valley civilization. There are some artifacts that clearly give the evidence of mathematical knowledge of the Indus valley people.
- Indian mathematics emerged in the Indian subcontinent from 1200 BCE until the end of the 18th century.
- In the classical period of Indian mathematics (400 CE to 1200 CE), important contributions were made by scholars like Aryabhata, Brahmagupta, Bhaskara II, and Varāhamihira.
- Indian mathematicians made seminal contributions to the study of trigonometry, algebra, arithmetic and negative numbers among other areas.
- Indian mathematics also gave us the concept of zero.

Physics in India and Ancient India

- The Nyaya and Vaisheshika philosophies encouraged a scientific culture in ancient India .
- Indian seers and scholars in the Vedic era made pioneering contributions to astronomy and basic physics, most of which have now been vindicated by rigorous theory and/or experiments .
- Ancient Indian theories lacked an empirical base, but they were brilliant imaginative explanations of the physical structure of the world, and in a large measure, agreed with the discoveries of modern physics .
- Early Indian thinkers developed a number of theoretical systems which centered around two main themes: elements and atoms .
- Maharishi Kanada was the first to systematically develop a theory of atomism around 200 BCE .
- The theory of atomism was further elaborated by the Buddhist atomists Dharmakirti and Dignāga during the 1st millennium CE .

Agriculture in India and Ancient India

- Agriculture in India has a long history, with evidence of domestication of plants and animals dating back to 9000 BC .
- The Mehrgarh period sites, which date back to around 8000-6000 BC, provide evidence of early agricultural practices in India .
- In ancient India, agriculture was closely associated with religious customs and traditions .
- The Vedic people were skilled in cultivation and succeeded in agriculture .
- In South India, a wide range of crops were cultivated, including rice, sugarcane, millets, black pepper, various grains, coconuts, beans, cotton, plantain, tamarind, and sandalwood .
- Agriculture in the Indian subcontinent was the largest producer of wheat and grain .
- Implements and techniques were developed for agriculture, leading to settled life .
- The Ganges River valley became an increasingly developed agricultural region after about 3000 BP .

Medicine in India and Ancient India

- Ayurveda is the most ancient system of Indian medicine which is gaining importance now in India.
- In the last part of the Vedic period, Indians attained a high degree of knowledge and wisdom due to which they were cultivated medicine, surgery, materia medica (medical material/substance), and chemistry.
- The ancient Indian system of medicine is thought to be the most methodical and holistic, both in terms of ideas and curative measures.
- Some of the most ancient practices of medicine and surgery were conducted here in India.
- Indian medicine has a long history. Its earliest concepts are set out in the sacred writings called the Vedas, especially in the metrical passages of the Atharvaveda, which may possibly date as far back as the 2nd millennium BCE.
- The ancient Indian medical system, also known as Ayurveda, is based on ancient writings that rely on a “natural” and holistic approach to physical and mental health. Ayurvedic medicine is one of the world’s oldest medical systems and remains one of India’s traditional health care systems.

Metallurgy in India and Ancient India

- Copper metallurgy in India dates back to the Chalcolithic societies in the subcontinent, according to spectrometric tests on copper ore samples discovered from ancient mine pits at Khetri in Rajasthan and metal samples cut from representative Harappan artefacts unearthed from Mitathal in Haryana.

- The ‘seven metals of antiquity’, as they are sometimes called, were, more or less in order of discovery: gold, copper, silver, lead, tin, iron and mercury. For over 7,000 years, India has had a high tradition of metallurgical skills.
- The history of metallurgy in the Indian subcontinent began prior to the 3rd millennium BCE. Metals and related concepts were mentioned in various early Vedic age texts. The Rigveda already uses the Sanskrit term *Ayas* (अयस) (metal).
- Zinc was extracted in India as early as in the 4th to 3rd century BCE. Zinc production may have begun in India, and ancient northwestern India is the earliest known civilization that produced zinc on an industrial scale. The distillation technique was developed around 1200 CE at Zawar in Rajasthan.
- The direct reduction method of iron extraction was used for a fairly long period in India’s history. Ancient Indians were masters in the production of iron and steel.
- Archeological studies reveal that iron working in India may have begun as early as 1800 BCE, and that by the early 13th century BCE, iron smelting was definitely practiced on a large scale.

Geography in India and Ancient India

- The geography of India is diverse, with landscapes ranging from snow-capped mountains and deserts to plains, hills, and plateaus.
- India got its name from the River Indus.
- In ancient times, the geography of India was a little different than what it is today.
- The northern part of India is bordered by the Himalayan Mountains, while the Hindu Kush stands in the northwest.
- The southern region of India is surrounded by three bodies of water.
- The Indian subcontinent is a diverse and fertile region with monsoons, droughts, plains, mountains, deserts, and especially rivers, along which early cities developed in the third millennium B.C.
- Along with Mesopotamia, Egypt, China, and Mesoamerica, the ancient Indian subcontinent was one of the few places in the world to develop its own civilization.
- Ancient India was bounded to the north by large mountains and to the south by the Indian Ocean. Major rivers flowed from the northern mountains.

Biology in India and Ancient India

- In the Vedic period, observations of plants and animals were carried out and recorded. 740 plants and 250 animals were recorded in the Vedic literature .
- Indian civilization probably dates back to about 6000 B.C. The Vedic Period is from 3000-8000 B.C. Information about this period comes from

the Vedas, a collection of four Sanskrit texts .

- Some researchers, using proper scientific methods, have proclaimed that biology in ancient India was not only at an advanced stage, but even better than the 20th century biological knowledge. Information about ancient plants and animals is available from both material (archaeological) and textual sources .
- As early as 2500 B.C., the people of northwestern India had a well-developed science of agriculture. The ruins at Mohenjo-daro have yielded seeds of wheat and barley that were cultivated at that time. Millet, dates, melons, and other fruits and vegetables, as well as cotton, were known to the civilization .
- The Project of History of Indian Science, Philosophy, and Culture has a Monograph series, Volume 3, titled “Mathematics, Astronomy, and Biology in Indian Tradition” edited by D. P. Chattopadhyaya and Ravinder Kumar .

Harappan Technologies in India and Ancient India

The Harappan Civilization, also known as the Indus Valley Civilization, was a Bronze Age civilization that extended from modern-day northeast Afghanistan to Pakistan and northwest India. It flourished from 3300-1300 BCE.

Some of the important innovations of this civilization include: - Standardized weights and measures. - Seal carving. - Metallurgy with copper, bronze, lead, and tin. - Tools and weapons were simple in form and comprised of flat-axes, chisels, arrowheads, spearheads, knives, saws, razors, and fish-hooks. - Advanced hydraulic engineering for conservation, harvesting, and storage of water.

Water Management in India and Ancient India

Water management has been an important aspect of Indian civilization for thousands of years. The need to manage water propelled the growth of hydrologic science in ancient India. Here are some key points about water management in India and Ancient India:

1. **Visvesvarayya**, the architect of water management in modern India, took inspiration from the ancient civilizations. Not only in water management, ancient Indian technology adopted simple, effective and sustainable methods in the domain of water treatment too.
2. **Hydrologic knowledge** in India has a historical footprint extending over several millenniums through the Harappan civilization (3000 –1500 BCE) and the Vedic Period (1500 –500 BCE).
3. **Mohenjo-Daro and Dholavira**, the two major cities of the Indus Valley, are the best examples of advanced water management and drainage systems. The Great Bath of Mohenjo-Daro of the Indus Valley is considered the “earliest public water tank of the ancient world”.
4. The **groundwater level** in India is estimated to have declined by 61%

between 2007 and 2017. The depletion of this vital resource not only threatens people's access to drinking water but also....

5. The **Harappan civilization** epitomizes the level of development of water sciences in ancient India that includes construction of sophisticated hydraulic structures, wastewater disposal systems....

Textile Technology in India and Ancient India

- Textiles was a great industry in ancient India. Some of the finest cloth in the world was from India. Textiles became one of the major commodities of trade between India and other countries.
- Cotton was also cultivated in India before anywhere else.
- The textile technology was highly developed in India. India was probably the first nation where the production of cotton fiber and the manufacture of textiles had started.
- India was highly skilled in making cotton fabrics, like China for silk. Indian cotton fabric was prized for its whiteness and fineness.
- The manufacturing of cotton into cloth by tools is an ancient art in India.
- The earliest surviving Indian cotton threads date to around 4000 BC and dyed fabrics from the region are documented as far back as 2500 BC.
- In ancient Greece and Babylon, the very name 'India' was shorthand for 'cotton'.
- India's textiles are embedded in every aspect of its identity.
- The story of textiles in India is one of the oldest in the world and goes back to prehistoric times. Concrete evidence of textile production and use starts appearing from the proto-historic times i.e. 3rd Millennium BCE.

Writing Technology in India and Ancient India

- Indic writing systems include the syllabic Kharosthi and semialphabetic Brahmi scripts of ancient India. No systems of writing subsequently developed from the Kharosthi script.
- Many phones and computers in India are not specifically designed with Indic script keyboards and instead use the Roman alphabet keyboards common in the West. Transliteration software renders this moot. The increased use of Indic-language scripts has also lead to newer and more artistic fonts for Indian languages.
- While India's scripts are ancient, technology and modernity are changing their usage patterns, and are in fact allowing them to thrive as never before in standardized and widely used forms.
- Ancient Indian scripts have been used in the history of the Indian sub-continent as writing systems. The Indian subcontinent consists of various separate linguistic communities, each of which share a common language and culture. The people of the ancient India wrote in many scripts which largely have common roots.

Pyrotechnics in India and Ancient India

- One of the earliest notes of pyrotechnical shows in India is made by Abdur Razzaq, the ambassador of the Timurid Sultan Shahrukh to the court of the Vijayanagar king Devaraya II in 1443 .
- Fireworks and pyrotechnic shows existed as a form of royal entertainment in many medieval Indian kingdoms during festivals, events and special occasions like weddings .
- Manufacturing formulas for fireworks describing pyrotechnic mixtures are found within Kautukachintamani, a Sanskrit volume by Gajapati Prataparudradeva (1497-1539), a reputed king of Orissa .
- There is no mention of fireworks in India before the end of the 15th century .
- Foreign travellers like Verthama have chronicled their use in Vijayanagar Empire .
- Kautuk Chintamani, compiled by Gajapati Pratap Chandra Rudra Dev of Orissa around the same time, also describes pyrotechnics as expensive amusement, fit for rulers and the very rich .

Trade in Ancient India

- Trade has existed in Ancient India since time immemorial. Routes such as the Silk Route, Amber Road, and the Spice Route were used to trade materials from India. Maritime trade, as well, flourished .
- India has thrived in trade since 2600 BC. During Harappan civilization, gold was the mainly traded good in the country .
- Ancient India saw trade since the Harappan civilization. The new cities that came up during the ancient times included Pataliputra, Ujjain, Puhar, and Mathura. Trade in the country during early years involved gold and then textiles, spices, as well as precious metals .
- Trade was an important source of commerce and it is thought that ancient Mesopotamian texts which mention Magan and Meluhha refer to India generally or, perhaps, Mohenjo-Daro specifically. Artifacts from the Indus Valley region have been found at sites in Mesopotamia though their precise point of origin in India is not always clear .
- Much of the significant data for long-distance and maritime trade across South Asia in the ancient period comes from archaeological sources. Nevertheless, textual sources too may have some things interesting and significant to say about material culture and trade in the ancient world .

India's Dominance up to Pre-colonial Times and Ancient India

- The history of India dates back to 2500 BC, which was when the Indus Valley cities were just starting to grow.
- The Indus Valley civilization existed around the Indus River between 3300 to 1300 BCE. It is also referred to as the Harappan Civilization.

- There were a number of empires ruling India from 2500 BC to 1857 AD including Mauryans, Guptas, Turks, Muslim, Mogul and more.
- Starting with the 16th century, parts of India were organized in different empires and kingdoms. Some of the most important empires in Indian territory were the Mughal Empire (1526- 1857), the Maratha Empire (1674-1818), and the Sikh Empire (1799-1849).
- The Mughal Empire was ruled by a Muslim dynasty, influenced by Persian culture.
- During the Gupta empire—from about 320 to 550 CE—emperors used Hinduism as a unifying religion and helped popularize it by promoting educational systems that included Hindu teachings; they also gave land to brahmins. The Gupta emperors helped make Hinduism the most popular religion on the Indian subcontinent.

Module 5- Cultural Heritage and Performing Arts

Cultural heritage refers to the legacy of physical artifacts and intangible attributes of a group or society that are inherited from past generations, maintained in the present, and bestowed for the benefit of future generations. Cultural heritage includes tangible culture (such as buildings, monuments, landscapes, books, works of art, and artifacts), intangible culture (such as folklore, traditions, language, and knowledge), and natural heritage (including culturally significant landscapes, and biodiversity).

Performing arts are a form of art in which artists use their voices, bodies, or inanimate objects to convey artistic expression. It is different from visual arts, which is when artists use paint, canvas, or various materials to create physical or static art objects. Performing arts include a range of disciplines which are performed in front of a live audience, including theatre, music, dance, opera, and circus arts.

1. Cultural heritage is important because it helps to define the identity of a group or society, and provides a sense of continuity and belonging.
2. The preservation of cultural heritage is important for future generations to learn about their history and traditions.
3. Performing arts provide a means of artistic expression and can be used to convey important messages and ideas.
4. The performing arts can also provide entertainment and enjoyment for audiences.
5. Both cultural heritage and performing arts can contribute to the development of a vibrant and diverse cultural landscape.

Indian Architecture in Ancient India and present times

Indian architecture is rooted in the history, culture, and religion of India. Among several architectural styles and traditions, the best-known include the many

varieties of Hindu temple architecture and Indo-Islamic architecture, especially Rajput architecture, Mughal architecture, South Indian architecture and Indo-Saracenic architecture .

The Mauryan period is considered as the beginning of the classical period of Indian architecture. Nagara and Dravidian architectural styles developed in the early medieval period with the rise of Hindu revivalism and predominant role of Hindu temple architecture in the Indian Subcontinent .

In the 20th century, the growth in the economy and population created a high demand for housing. Globalisation and a migratory population led to a shift in Indian architecture from a holistic point of view .

Some examples of ancient Indian architecture include the Ajanta caves, the Humayun Tomb, and the grandeur of the Vijayanagara Empire- Hampi .

Engineering and Architecture as Cultural Heritage of India

1. Indian architecture is rooted in the history, culture, and religion of India. Among several architectural styles and traditions, the best-known include the many varieties of Hindu temple architecture and Indo-Islamic architecture, especially Rajput architecture, Mughal architecture, South Indian architecture and Indo-Saracenic architecture .
2. The framework of protecting Architectural heritage was introduced about 150 years back when the Archeological Survey of India (ASI) was established by the British colonial government. It deliberately supplanted indigenous practices and information frameworks, in this way making the split between official and local practices which has tormented preservation process in India ever since .
3. India through its prosperous cultural heritage and rich history has witnessed the rise and fall of several great dynasties which is conspicuous through the greatness of ancient Indian architecture. The magnificence of these buildings, monuments, bridges, forts, halls, mosques, temples, and churches makes one fully comprehend the glorious periods through which India has passed .
4. India's architecture continues to diversify as the country grows, reverting to its traditions while adhering to modern trends and minority communities .
5. Engineering and Architecture in Ancient and Medieval India includes Civil Works of Indus Valley-Vedic-Post-Vedic period, Buddhist Stupas and Viharas, Temple architecture, Rock-Cut architecture and Indo-Islamic architecture .

Sculptures as Cultural Heritage of India

- Sculpture art is one of the oldest art forms to exist in India, rooting itself as a widespread practice even in the ancient Indus Valley Civilisation (c.3300-1300 BCE).

- The subject matter of Indian sculpture was almost invariably abstracted human forms that were used to instruct people in the truths of the Hindu, Buddhist, or Jain religions.
- The nude was used both to represent the body as a symbol of spirit and to reveal the imagined shapes of the gods.
- Indian sculpture artists have always been fascinated by figures from mythology and religion as it runs strongly in our culture.
- Sculptures of Hindu gods and goddesses, Lord Buddha, figures from Christianity and so on are some of the most common themes in sculpture art as seen from the ancient times.
- Some of the famous sculptures in India are:
 1. The Dancing Girl, Mohen Jo Daro, c. 2500 BC.
 2. Ashoka Pillar, Sarnath, third Century B.C..
 3. Buddha.
- Cultural awareness promotes a better understanding of our heritage to effectively safeguard and spread India's rich intangible and tangible cultural art heritage, such as paintings and sculptures.

Seals as Cultural Heritage of India

- Seals have been an integral part of the cultural heritage of India, particularly in the Indus Valley Civilization.
- The famous seals of the Indus Valley Civilization are small rectangular pieces that have been found in abundance across the expanse of the civilization. They have been called seals as their imprint has been found on clay pieces with remnants of cloth fiber .
- Seals were used in ancient times for trade and were rectangular, circular, or even cylindrical in shape .
- One of the most commonly discovered artifacts in Indus Valley cities are seals decorated with animal figures, such as elephants, tigers, and water buffalos .
- The Pashupati seal is one of the most famous seals from the Indus Valley Civilization and is currently housed in the National Museum in New Delhi .
- Seals provide useful information about the civilization of the Indus Valley and are an important part of India's cultural heritage .

Coins as Cultural Heritage of India

1. The history of coins of India originates from the years of Indus Valley civilisation. Cowry Shells were the first to be used as a symbol of money. Sites like Harappa and Mohenjo Daro show the use of metal coins as a means of trading and exchange of goods.
2. Gold coins in ancient India reached their peak with the Gupta emperors from the 3rd to 6th century AD. This was India's Golden Age, where there

was prosperity all around, and people lived the good life, full of culture and joy.

3. The Coinage of India has played a very important role in the history of economic development of the country ever since its inception. The motifs, symbols, stamp used on the Indian coins since ancient times depict a lot about the rulers and their reign. Many archaeologists and explorers have done a deep analysis of these ancient Indian coins.
4. Many dynasties ruled over India and each of them introduced their coins which depicted their culture and beliefs. These coins are generally placed between the 2nd century BC and 2nd century AD.

Pottery as Cultural Heritage of India

- Pottery in the Indian subcontinent has an ancient history and is one of the most tangible and iconic elements of Indian art.
- Evidence of pottery has been found in the early settlements of Lahuradewa and later the Indus Valley Civilisation.
- Today, it is a cultural art that is still practiced extensively in Indian subcontinent.
- Pottery plays an important role in studying culture and reconstructing the past.
- Pottery is among the most timeless living craft traditions of India.
- From flower pots, terracotta chimes to the thirst-quenching suraahi and matki, pottery is practised across the length and breadth of the country.
- A visit to the countryside and “potter’ villages” speaks volumes about the economic importance of this craft.

Puppetry as Cultural Heritage of India

- Puppetry is one of India’s most diverse cultural heritages, with a variety of regional genres .
- Indian puppetry is a subject as varied as the many cultural traditions of the Indian subcontinent.
- Puppetry has been in India a means of entertainment and a form of cultural and religious dissemination.
- In the post-colonial period, the high-speed modernization wave that invested India put many of the puppetry traditions at risk of extinction; several government and private initiatives contributed to save endangered styles, but many are still at risk.
- Indian Heritage Puppetry is a fascinating art form that has always sparked curiosity from an audience of all ages.
- Emerging from the grassroots level, the identification of puppetry in India varies from one location to the other.
- Aside from traditional puppetry, India has a thriving contemporary puppetry culture.

Dance as Cultural Heritage of India

- India celebrates its classical dance culture, a priceless heritage of the ancient times. The Indian classical dance forms have made it to international heights from the four walls of temples and royal courts.
- The origins of dance in India go back into the ancient times. The earliest paleolithic and neolithic cave paintings such as the UNESCO world heritage site at Bhimbetka rock shelters in Madhya Pradesh shows dance scenes.
- Every part of India has its unique folk dance, which reflects the deep-seated beliefs of their people.
- Dance is an ancient and celebrated cultural tradition in India. Folk dances abound all across the country, and huge crowds of people can be found dancing at festivals and weddings. Dance and song features heavily in Indian cinema (so-called “Bollywood” films), too.
- The various forms of dance that come under the umbrella have their roots in Hindu religious musical theatres. The Sangeet Natak Academy recognises eight classical dance forms in India, namely, Bharatnatyam, Kathak, Kuchipudi, Kathakali, Odissi, Mohiniyattam, Manipuri and Satriya.

Music as Cultural Heritage of India

1. India is a land of cultural diversities, with every region having its own form of folk music. This rich tradition of folk music is very much alive in not just rural India, but also in some metros.
2. The music of India includes Indian classical music, multiple varieties of folk, popular, pop, and, most recently, rock music. The origins of Indian classical music can be found in the oldest Hindu scriptures, the Vedas.
3. There are two major traditions of Indian classical music. They are Carnatic music, a style associated with South India, and Hindustani music, a style associated with North India.
4. Indian music has always had strong ties with mythology and religion and thus produced an art that is as different from Western music as Hinduism is from Christianity. It achieves unity through similarity rather than through change and is based on a more purely sensual experience.
5. The music of India is as diverse as its many cultures. India has over a billion people and hundreds of dialects and languages spread across the seventh largest country in the world, but there is still an undeniable “sound” that makes Indian music unmistakable.

Theatre as Cultural Heritage of India

1. India has a long, rich and illustrious history of folk theatre.
2. Folk theatre is a composite art form in India, with a fusion of elements from music, dance, and many forms.
3. It has deep roots in local identity and native culture and is an important indigenous tool of interpersonal communication.

4. India has the most ancient form of theatre as textual, sculptural, and dramatic -the Natya Shastra.
5. The Natya Shastra is the authentic text of theatre art, originated around 500 BC.
6. It is classical and written in Sanskrit by Bharat Muni.
7. Theatre in ancient India played a major role in the overall enrichment of Indian tradition, culture, artistry and creativity since the remote past.
8. The origin of theatre in ancient India has been marked as the result of the religious ritualism of the “Vedic Aryans”.
9. As theatre developed in India and began to flourish again, three types of historical Indian theatre evolved: the classical period, the traditional period, and the modern period.
10. The traditional regional forms of theatre have today reached the stage of heritage, with some, such as Koodiyattam officially being recognized by UNESCO as a Masterpiece of the Oral and Intangible Heritage of Humanity.
11. Kutiyattam, Sanskrit theatre, which is practised in the province of Kerala, is one of India’s oldest living theatrical traditions.
12. Originating more than 2,000 years ago, Kutiyattam represents a synthesis of Sanskrit classicism and reflects the local traditions of Kerala.

Drama as Cultural Heritage of India

- Traditional theatre has been prevalent in India since ancient times. It was enacted by bards who traveled from one village to another, and the stories were based on epics of Mahabharat and Ramayan, as well as the Puranas and Upanishads.
- Indian drama has originated and developed from the storehouse of Sanskrit in India. It has given its incredible impact and limit to perfection since ancient times. Drama is basically a form of performing arts, where stories are enacted by the utilization of dialogue, music, signal, and dance.
- Since the beginning of our civilization, music, dance, and drama have been an integral aspect of our culture. Initially, these art forms were used as a medium of propagation for religion and social reforms in which music and dance were incorporated to gain popularity. From the Vedic era to the medieval period, the performing arts remained an important source of educating the masses.
- Indian drama is a performance style all its own, including combinations of speech, gesture, music, dance, and sound. Indian drama was highly uninfluenced by other cultures.
- Urdu Drama evolved from the prevailing dramatic traditions of North India shaping Rahas or Raas as practiced by exponents like Wajid Ali Shah, Nawab of Awadh. His dramatic experiments led to the famous Inder Sabha of Agha Hasan Amanat and later this tradition took the shape of Parsi theatre.

Painting as Cultural Heritage of India

- Indian art is among the oldest in the world, with archaeologists discovering paintings that were created over 70,000 years ago .
- Indian paintings hold a special place in history and continue to influence artists to this day .
- Traditional art in India depicted cultural, religious, and political developments through clever metaphors .
- Indian art forms, including paintings, are a part of the country's rich culture and heritage .
- Beautiful bursts of color with vivid patterns and symbolic images capture Indian culture beautifully on the canvas .
- There are many different types of Indian paintings, including Madhubani, Warli, and Murals, each with its own unique style and history .
- Indian paintings have a rich history and diversity, with the earliest known Indian paintings dating back to pre-historic times, such as those found in places like Bhimbetka rock shelters in Madhya Pradesh .
- India has one of the world's largest collections of songs, music, dance, theatre, folk traditions, performing arts, rites and rituals, paintings and writings that are known as the 'Intangible Cultural Heritage' (ICH) of humanity .

Martial Arts Traditions of India

- Martial arts are codified systems and traditions of combat practices, which are practised for a variety of reasons – self-defence, competition, physical health and fitness, entertainment, as well as mental, physical, and spiritual development.
- India has an ancient tradition in diverse martial arts.
- India's Martial traditions originated in South India.
- India has its own wrestling art called Khusti.
- Indian Martial arts have influenced Asian martial arts in significant ways.
- Kushti is one of the most popular martial arts in India.
- Kalaripayattu is often known as the 'Mother Of All Martial Arts'.
- This 3000-year old art form originating from Kerala, draws inspiration from the raw power, swift movements and sinuous strength of majestic animals – the lion, tiger, elephant, wild boar, snake and crocodile.
- The ancient Manipuri Martial Art, also known as Huyen Lallong, is Thang-Ta.
- Swords and spears are used in Manipuri Martial arts, a powerful yet gracefully complex technique.
- Lathi is India's oldest armed martial art.
- It is also regarded as one of the world's earliest martial arts weapons.

Fairs and Festivals as Cultural Heritage of India

India is known for its vibrant and diverse culture, and fairs and festivals are an integral part of this culture. These celebrations offer a unique way of experiencing Indian culture at its best. Some of the most famous fairs and festivals of India include:

1. **Modhera Dance Festival of Gujarat:** Also called the Uttarardh Mahotsavaor, this festival is a cultural celebration inside the premises of Modhera Sun Temple.
2. **Pongal of South India:** Pongal is the harvest festival of the land.
3. **Konark Dance Festival of Odisha.**
4. **Jaisalmer Desert Festival.**
5. **Goa Carnival.**
6. **Nehru Trophy Boat Race of Kerala.**
7. **Pushkar Mela.**
8. **Bikaner Camel Festival.**

These are just a few examples of the numerous fairs and festivals celebrated in India. Each festival has its own unique customs and traditions, and they are celebrated with great enthusiasm and spirit by the people of India. These celebrations provide a glimpse into the rich cultural heritage of India.

Current developments in Arts and Cultural in India

- India has a rich cultural heritage and is home to 37 world heritage sites, two thriving film industries, and a diversely vibrant cultural heritage.
- Several cities in India are actively working towards creating a unique cultural identity for themselves.
- Three cities in India, Thrissur and Nilambur in Kerala and Warangal in Telangana, have recently joined the UNESCO Global Network of Learning Cities.
- The Kiran Nadar Museum of Art is developing a new institution, the Museum of Art and Photography will open in Bangalore, the Gujral Foundation is commissioning a public pavilion series in Delhi, and the Kochi Biennale will have its fifth edition this December.
- The Ministry of Culture, Government of India, provides financial assistance for cultural activities in performing arts, allied cultural activities, and for the promotion of art and culture.
- India has nominated Hoysala Temples for inscription in the World Heritage List and has recently got back a Goat-Headed Yogini Statue.

Indian's Cultural Contribution to the World

India has made many significant contributions to the world in various fields. Here are some of the most notable contributions:

1. **Mathematics:** Hindus were precursors to mathematics. They made sig-

nificant contributions to the field of mathematics, including the invention of the concept of zero and the decimal system.

2. **Architecture:** India is known for its picturesque and quirky urban architecture.
3. **Textiles:** The cotton fabrics produced in India are among the best in the world.
4. **Medicine:** Hindus knew the technique to sterilize and use drugs to heal the sick.
5. **Language:** India is the richest linguistic nation in the world.
6. **Art:** India has a rich tradition of art, including painting, sculpture, literature, music, dance, and theatre.
7. **Culture:** Indian culture has greatly increased in prevalence and popularity over the last few decades. All aspects of Indian culture have manifested in various forms throughout popular American culture.

These are just a few examples of the many contributions that India has made to the world. India's diverse and talented population has introduced many precious things to the world, and its contributions have become the base for several modern innovations.

Indian Cinema as a Performing Art in India

- India is a powerhouse of performing arts, showcasing talent like nothing else. Indian cinema is one of the unique art forms that sew a cultural lore with resplendent costumes, dazzling jewelry, quaint adornments, and traditional practices.
- Indian cinema has evolved as a potent art form capable of mirroring socio-political and economic issues plaguing India. Films like *Achhut Kanya* (1936) and *Sujata* (1959) are examples of such cinema.
- The year 1931 proved to be a landmark for Indian cinema as it marked the end of the silent era with Ardeshir Irani making India's first sound film *Alam Ara*, made in Hindi/Urdu. The early commercial success of Phalke's films not only paved the way for more such motion pictures but also set the ball rolling for cinema as a commercial art form.
- Indian cinema is known for producing the largest number of films in the world. India has one of Asia's largest film industries and employs thousands of people. The Indian film industry makes films in Hindi, Telugu, Tamil, Bhojpuri, and other languages.